

CYBER THREAT INTELLIGENCE REPORT

Sample Test Document — Q2 2025

Classification:	TLP:WHITE — Unrestricted Distribution
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1. Executive Summary

This report provides a comprehensive overview of observed threat actor activity, newly identified malware campaigns, and critical vulnerability disclosures relevant to enterprise environments. The findings are based on open-source intelligence (OSINT), dark web monitoring, honeypot telemetry, and partner sharing arrangements. Organizations are advised to review the indicators of compromise (IoCs) and apply recommended mitigations within 72 hours.

Key Findings

#	Finding	Severity	Priority
1	APT-41 lateral movement via Living-off-the-Land (LotL) techniques	CRITICAL	P1
2	Novel ransomware strain 'LockViper' targeting healthcare sector	HIGH	P1
3	Zero-day in Apache HTTP Server 2.4.x (CVE-2025-1337)	HIGH	P2
4	Credential stuffing campaign against financial institutions	MEDIUM	P2
5	Supply-chain compromise via malicious npm packages	HIGH	P1

2. Threat Actor Profiles

APT-41 (Double Dragon)	China-nexus	CRITICAL
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APT-41 continues dual-mission espionage and financially motivated operations. Recent campaigns leverage LOLBins (certutil, mshta, regsvr32) to evade endpoint detection. Observed TTPs include spear-phishing via LinkedIn, exploitation of public-facing applications, and deployment of SHADOWPAD malware for persistent access.

LockViper Group	Financially Motivated / RaaS	HIGH
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Newly identified ransomware-as-a-service operation targeting healthcare and critical infrastructure. The group uses triple extortion (encrypt + exfiltrate + DDoS) with average ransom demands of \$2.3M. Affiliates gain initial access via unpatched VPN appliances and exposed RDP.

UNC-3890	Iran-nexus	MEDIUM
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Iranian state-sponsored actor focused on defence, aerospace, and logistics sectors. Primarily uses credential harvesting via fake login portals and watering-hole attacks. Linked to NEMESIS KITTEN cluster with partial code overlap in C2 infrastructure.

3. Malware Analysis: LockViper

LockViper is a Rust-based ransomware strain discovered in March 2025. It employs ChaCha20-Poly1305 encryption for file content and RSA-4096 for key encapsulation. The malware performs extensive pre-encryption reconnaissance including domain enumeration, shadow copy deletion, and backup software termination.

Execution Flow

Stage	Action	MITRE ATT&CK
1 — Initial Access	Exploit VPN CVE / Phishing attachment	T1190 / T1566
2 — Execution	PowerShell dropper via mshta.exe	T1059.001
3 — Persistence	Registry Run key + Scheduled Task	T1547.001
4 — Defense Evasion	Process hollowing, AMSI bypass	T1055 / T1562
5 — Discovery	Active Directory enumeration via LDAP	T1018
6 — Lateral Movement	Pass-the-Hash / WMI remote exec	T1550.002
7 — Exfiltration	MEGAsync client for data staging	T1567.002
8 — Impact	File encryption + ransom note drop	T1486

4. Indicators of Compromise (IoCs)

The following IoCs are associated with observed LockViper and APT-41 campaigns. Organizations should block these at perimeter firewalls, proxy, and EDR platforms immediately.

Type	Indicator	Confidence	Campaign
IPv4	185.220.101.47	HIGH	LockViper C2
IPv4	91.108.56.199	HIGH	APT-41 C2
Domain	update-cdn-service[.]com	HIGH	LockViper drop
Domain	ms-windowsupdate[.]net	MEDIUM	APT-41 phish
SHA-256	3a9f2c1b...e74d (truncated)	HIGH	LockViper binary
SHA-256	bf120e3d...9a01 (truncated)	HIGH	SHADOWPAD loader
URL	hxxps://cdn-delivery[.]xyz/payload.bin	MEDIUM	LockViper stage2
Mutex	Global\{F4A2C1D9-...}	MEDIUM	LockViper runtime
Reg Key	HKCU\Software\Microsoft\Update\v3	HIGH	LockViper persist

5. Vulnerability Advisory

CVE ID	Affected Product	CVSS	Status	Patch
CVE-2025-1337	Apache HTTP Server 2.4.x	9.8	Exploited ITW	2.4.63
CVE-2025-2201	Fortinet FortiOS 7.x	9.1	PoC Public	7.4.5
CVE-2025-0891	VMware vCenter 8.x	8.8	Patch Available	8.0 U3b
CVE-2024-9999	Cisco IOS XE	7.5	Workaround	17.12.3

6. Recommendations

IMMEDIATE (0–24 hrs)

- Block all listed IP addresses and domains at perimeter firewall and DNS sinkhole.
- Apply Apache HTTP Server patch (CVE-2025-1337) — exploitation in the wild confirmed.
- Invalidate and rotate credentials for privileged accounts (Domain Admin, Service Accounts).

SHORT-TERM (1–7 days)

- Enable MFA on all VPN, RDP, and cloud management consoles.
- Deploy YARA rules and Sigma detections for LockViper TTPs (provided in Appendix A).
- Audit scheduled tasks and registry Run keys for unknown entries.

STRATEGIC (7–30 days)

- Conduct tabletop exercise simulating ransomware scenario against critical assets.
- Review and update incident response playbooks for ransomware and APT intrusion.
- Evaluate network segmentation — lateral movement observed across flat networks.

Appendix A — Sample YARA Rule

```
rule LockViper_Ransomware {
  meta:
    description = "Detects LockViper ransomware binary"
    author      = "CTI Test Suite"
    date        = "2025-04-10"
    severity    = "CRITICAL"
  strings:
    $ransom_note = "YOUR FILES HAVE BEEN ENCRYPTED BY LOCKVIPER" ascii
    $mutex       = "Global\\{F4A2C1D9" wide
    $ext         = ".lockviper" ascii
    $pdb         = "lockviper_core.pdb" ascii
  condition:
    uint16(0) == 0x5A4D and 2 of them
}
```

Appendix B — References

- MITRE ATT&CK; Framework v14 — <https://attack.mitre.org>
- CISA KEV Catalog — <https://www.cisa.gov/known-exploited-vulnerabilities-catalog>
- VirusTotal Intelligence Feed (proprietary)
- Apache Security Advisory ASF-2025-001
- Fortinet PSIRT Advisory FG-IR-25-001